

API Deployment

At Tyk, we offer multiple deployment methods to match the maturity and scale of your API projects — from simple experiments to full-scale GitOps.

File-Based Configurations

- File-based Configurations
- Best For: Open Source users and initial testing
 - Configure APIs using JSON specs
 - Load configs into /apps folder
 - Great for quick iterations
- Usage:
 - Testing gateway & API configs in Open Source setups

Dashboard UI

- Dashboard UI
- Best For: PoC, Trials, and manual learning
 - Intuitive web GUI
 - Instant feedback from changes
 - Easily import and edit APIs
- Usage:
 - PoC, hands-on exploration, and testing

Dashboard or Gateway API

- Dashboard or Gateway API
- Best For: Programmatic access & automation
 - Use REST APIs to manage APIs, Policies, Keys, etc.
 - Enables scripting and partial automation
 - Imperative (not declarative) style
- Usage:
 - Teams needing API-level control and scripting

Tyk Sync

- Tyk Sync
- Best For: GitOps-style automation
 - Declarative config in transportable format
 - Store API definitions in Git
 - Enables CI/CD for APIs
- Usage:
 - Automated, version-controlled API deployments

Tyk Operator

- Tyk Operator
- Best For: Kubernetes-native environments
 - Treat APIs & Policies as K8s Custom Resources
 - Continuous reconciliation with Git
 - Built on Tyk Sync & GitOps principles
- Usage:
 - Kubernetes users who want declarative, drift-resistant API management